



# RECENT SPIKE IN SOMALI PIRACY AND MARITIME THREAT ACTIVITY

*Conflict Systems Analysis: Maritime Security Intelligence Assessment*

| DOMAIN                    | PRODUCER                         | FRAMEWORK    | DATE                       |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------|----------------------------|
| Conflict Systems Analysis | M. Nuri Shakoor / MNS Consulting | QAP™ / SATs  | May 2026                   |
| CONFIDENCE                | CLASSIFICATION                   | THREAT LEVEL | SCOPE                      |
| Moderate-High             | Public / OSINT                   | HIGH         | Somali Basin, Gulf of Aden |

**ANALYTIC SCOPE BOUNDARY**

This assessment covers reported piracy and maritime threat activity during the primary 30-day window ending 06 May 2026, compares the pattern against the prior 24-month baseline, and projects a 90-day forward monitoring horizon. It excludes unverified social media claims, speculative insurgent linkage claims, and non-maritime criminality. Confidence is driven by primary maritime reporting, source independence, incident specificity, and unresolved attribution gaps. Open-source only; no classified intelligence streams are incorporated.

| THREAT LEVEL | FORWARD HORIZON | CORE KIQs | SOURCE STREAMS | CONFIDENCE | FRAMEWORK |
|--------------|-----------------|-----------|----------------|------------|-----------|
| HIGH         | 90 DAYS         | 5         | 6              | MOD-HIGH   | QAP™      |

Produced under the Quanta Analytica Process™. All claims traced to open-source evidence or labelled as analyst inference. No fabricated sources, quotes, or data.

01 // BLUF

## Bottom Line Up Front

- 01 [ASSESS]** Somali piracy has transitioned from residual criminal risk into a renewed organized operational threat cycle. Primary maritime advisories and naval reporting indicate repeated vessel incidents, held merchant vessels, and Pirate Action Group activity across the Somali Coast and Somali Basin. [S1][S2][S3]
- 02 [FACT]** Dhow mothership use is the key operational accelerant. Reported hijacking and suspected use of dhows as motherships materially expands pirate reach beyond nearshore attacks and increases route uncertainty for merchant traffic. [S2][S3][S4]
- 03 [CAVEAT]** Direct Houthi or insurgent coordination remains unproven in public evidence. Red Sea instability likely enables piracy by stretching deterrence resources and altering risk perception, but current public reporting does not prove operational coordination between Somali pirate actors and Houthi-aligned networks. [S2][S6]
- 04 [ASSESS]** The next 90 days carry high risk for slow, low-freeboard, poorly hardened vessels. The most exposed routes and assets are merchant vessels operating near Puntland-linked areas, the Somali Basin, and Arabian Sea approaches where mothership-enabled PAG activity can extend threat range. [S2][S3][S5]

02 // KIQs

## Key Intelligence Questions

| ID    | Intelligence Question                                                                              | Links To                          |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| KIQ-1 | Does the current spike represent opportunistic criminality or organized piracy reconstitution?     | KJ-1, ACH H1/H2, Gap G1           |
| KIQ-2 | Are regional naval resource reallocations reducing deterrence effectiveness?                       | KJ-2, Scenario Base/Worst, I&W-4  |
| KIQ-3 | Are pirate operational capabilities expanding offshore through mothership logistics?               | KJ-3, Risk Matrix, I&W-1          |
| KIQ-4 | What escalation pathways could emerge over the next 90 days?                                       | KJ-4, Scenario Matrix, Thresholds |
| KIQ-5 | Which indicators would signal transition from episodic piracy to sustained operational resurgence? | Annex A, Collection Gaps          |

03 // SNAPSHOT

## Situation Snapshot

|       |                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WHO   | Somali Pirate Action Groups, merchant crews, EUNAVFOR ATALANTA, CMF/CTF-151, UKMTO/JMIC, shipping operators, and Puntland-linked coastal actors. |
| WHAT  | A late-April and early-May spike in piracy incidents, hijackings, suspicious approaches, and mothership-enabled offshore activity.               |
| WHERE | Northern Somali coast, Puntland approaches, Somali Basin, Gulf of Aden, and western Arabian Sea shipping lanes.                                  |
| WHEN  | Primary analytic window: last 30 days ending 06 May 2026. Forecast horizon: next 90 days.                                                        |
| WHY   | The pattern affects shipping risk, insurance exposure, naval planning, NGO movement, and energy/logistics continuity.                            |
| HOW   | Hijacked dhows, skiff approaches, vessel holding, permissive maritime conditions, and perceived deterrence gaps.                                 |

## 04 // KEY JUDGMENTS

## Prioritized Key Judgments

| CONFIDENCE                     | JUDGMENT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MODERATE-H<br>IGHKJ-1 // KIQ-1 | [ASSESS] The piracy spike is most consistent with organized network reactivation rather than isolated opportunistic criminality. The judgment rests on repeated incidents, vessel holding, mothership use, and offshore range extension. Maps to: ACH H2   Sources: [S1][S2][S3][S4] |
| MODERATEKJ<br>-2 // KIQ-2      | [ASSESS] Red Sea and broader regional maritime instability likely functions as an enabling condition by stretching maritime security attention and shaping pirate perceptions of lower interdiction risk. Maps to: ACH H3   Sources: [S2][S6]                                        |
| HIGHKJ-3 // KIQ-3              | [FACT/ASSESS] Dhow mothership use materially expands the threat envelope and permits attacks far offshore, increasing risk to vessels that previously relied on distance from the Somali coast as a protective factor. Maps to: Maritime Vulnerability   Sources: [S2][S3][S4]       |
| WATCHKJ-4 // KIQ-4             | [WATCH] Direct pirate-insurgent or pirate-Houthi coordination remains analytically plausible but unproven. Upgrade only if financial, communications, detainee, or operational evidence links the actors. Maps to: Gap G4   Sources: no Tier A support yet                           |

## 05 // EVIDENCE

## Evidence Summary

### WHAT WE KNOW

- EUNAVFOR confirmed incidents involving HONOUR 25 and SWORD.
- UKMTO/JMIC assessed Somali Coast and Somali Basin piracy threat as severe.
- JMIC reporting identified held vessels and dhow mothership concern.
- CMF/CTF-151 reported counter-piracy response off Somalia.

### WHAT WE ASSESS

- Operational behavior exceeds random coastal opportunism.
- Dormant pirate logistics likely retained enough capacity for reactivation.
- Successful incidents may create copycat incentives and confidence amplification.
- Regional maritime crises likely dilute deterrence perception.

### WHAT WE DO NOT KNOW

- Full command structure of active PAGs.
- Whether separate incidents are centrally coordinated.
- Ransom negotiation status and financial intermediaries.
- Any material insurgent or Houthi facilitation link.

### KEY DRIVERS

- [FACT] Severe maritime advisory posture.
- [FACT] Mothership-enabled operating range.
- [INFERENCE] Lower perceived interdiction risk.
- [INFERENCE] Demonstration effect from successful hijackings.

### BINDING CONSTRAINTS

- Resource: regional naval forces face multiple maritime missions.
- Geographic: Somali Basin and Arabian Sea approaches are wide operating spaces.
- Evidence: public data cannot resolve command links or financing channels.
- Operational: weather and vessel speed/freeboard affect vulnerability.

**WSI Source Independence Note:** Load-bearing claims use at least two primary or authoritative streams where available. Syndicated news and reporting that derives from the same UKMTO/JMIC or EUNAVFOR advisories are treated as a single corroboration stream. Insurgent-link and Houthi-link claims remain below key-judgment threshold.

06 // ANALYSIS

Structured Analytic Tradecraft

**Techniques Applied:** Five-Layer Strategic Cognition Map, Key Assumptions Check, Analysis of Competing Hypotheses, Indicators and Warnings, Scenario Modeling, Risk Matrix, and Maritime Chokepoint Vulnerability Assessment.

FIVE-LAYER STRATEGIC COGNITION MAP

| LAYER          | APPLICATION TO SOMALI PIRACY SPIKE                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| L1 FOUNDATIONS | Puntland-linked coastal geography, legacy piracy know-how, merchant traffic density, naval patrol architecture, and weak maritime governance create the structural field.                                       |
| L2 MECHANISMS  | Hijacked dhows extend range, low-cost skiff operations create attack options, perceived deterrence gaps alter risk-reward calculations, and ransom potential converts maritime access into revenue opportunity. |
| L3 DYNAMICS    | Successful hijackings can trigger copycat activation, confidence amplification, community tolerance, and adaptive targeting farther offshore.                                                                   |
| L4 LEVERAGE    | Mothership interdiction, transit hardening, rapid reporting, ISR concentration, and ransom denial are the most plausible disruption points.                                                                     |
| L5 PARADIGMS   | Piracy may be framed locally as survival or anti-illegal-fishing resistance, while shipping actors view it as criminal maritime predation. Competing legitimacy frames shape tolerance and deterrence.          |

KEY ASSUMPTIONS CHECK

| ID | ASSUMPTION                                                              | WHY IT MATTERS                                   | RISK IF WRONG                                                      | STATUS                                           |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| A1 | Recent incidents are attributable to Somali pirate actors.              | Anchors actor attribution and response planning. | Could misdirect mitigation if criminal actors are not Somali PAGs. | Active, supported by primary maritime reporting. |
| A2 | Mothership use indicates organized planning rather than isolated theft. | Drives network reconstitution judgment.          | Overstates sophistication if dhow use is episodic.                 | Active.                                          |
| A3 | Regional maritime crises reduce effective deterrence.                   | Explains timing and enabling conditions.         | Overweights external drivers if local drivers dominate.            | Unverified but plausible.                        |
| A4 | Ransom economics remain viable enough to motivate repeat attempts.      | Shapes 90-day forecast.                          | Threat may decline if monetization fails.                          | Unverified; collection priority.                 |

ANALYSIS OF COMPETING HYPOTHESES

| HYPOTHESIS                  | EVIDENCE FOR                                                                       | EVIDENCE AGAINST                                                                     | DIAG. | VERDICT              |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------------|
| H1 Opportunistic spike      | Economic stress and maritime opportunity can produce short-term attacks.           | Multiple held vessels, offshore range, and mothership use exceed simple opportunism. | 3     | Partial explanation. |
| H2 Organized reconstitution | Best fit for repeat incidents, PAG activity, dhow motherships, and vessel holding. | Public evidence does not yet prove a single command structure.                       | 5     | Most supported.      |
| H3 Red Sea spillover        | Regional maritime crisis likely dilutes attention and encourages risk-taking.      | Does not independently explain local logistics and pirate capabilities.              | 4     | Enabling condition.  |

| HYPOTHESIS                    | EVIDENCE FOR                                                                 | EVIDENCE AGAINST                                                                   | DIAG. | VERDICT            |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|--------------------|
| H4 Economic survival behavior | Coastal stress and illegal fishing grievances provide permissive narratives. | Does not explain operational coordination alone.                                   | 3     | Background driver. |
| H5 Insurgent financing        | Piracy can theoretically intersect with militant financing.                  | No strong public evidence links current incidents to insurgent command or funding. | 2     | Watch only.        |

## INDICATORS AND WARNINGS

| INDICATOR                                           | DIRECTION     | CURRENT STATUS               | THRESHOLD                                      | CADENCE |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------|
| New dhow hijackings or missing fishing vessels      | Escalatory    | Active concern               | Two or more new cases in 14 days               | Daily   |
| PAG approaches beyond 300 nm offshore               | Escalatory    | Reported in advisory context | Confirmed approach beyond 500 nm               | Daily   |
| Merchant vessels redirected toward Somali coast     | Escalatory    | Observed in recent reporting | Any new confirmed forced movement              | Daily   |
| JMIC/UKMTO threat posture                           | Status marker | Severe                       | Severe sustained for 14 days or raised further | Daily   |
| Ransom communications or release-for-payment claims | Escalatory    | Unknown                      | Verified ransom demand or payment              | Daily   |

## SCENARIO MATRIX

| SCENARIO            | TRIGGER                                        | DYNAMICS                                                                                                           | PROBABILITY                    |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| BEST / SUPPRESSION  | Rapid disruption of mothership cycle           | Coordinated naval action recovers hijacked dhows, disrupts PAG logistics, and reduces copycat incentives.          | 15%   Moderate confidence      |
| BASE / CONTINUATION | Intermittent hijackings and approaches persist | PAGs continue testing vulnerable vessels while deterrence remains uneven across the Somali Basin.                  | 55%   Moderate-High confidence |
| WORST / ESCALATION  | Multi-vessel hostage and tanker-risk cycle     | Successful monetization leads to more participants, bolder offshore attacks, and materially higher shipping costs. | 30%   Moderate confidence      |

## RISK MATRIX

| RISK                     | LIKELIHOOD (1-5) | IMPACT (1-5) | SCORE       | MITIGANT                                           |
|--------------------------|------------------|--------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Merchant vessel boarding | 4                | 4            | 16 HIGH     | BMP compliance, citadel readiness, routing review. |
| Offshore PAG expansion   | 4                | 4            | 16 HIGH     | Mothership interdiction, ISR, rapid reporting.     |
| Tanker hijacking attempt | 3                | 5            | 15 HIGH     | Armed security review, speed/freeboard screening.  |
| NGO maritime disruption  | 3                | 4            | 12 MOD-HIGH | Movement approvals, contingency routing.           |

| RISK                     | LIKELIHOOD<br>(1-5) | IMPACT (1-5) | SCORE      | MITIGANT                                      |
|--------------------------|---------------------|--------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Direct insurgent linkage | 2                   | 4            | 8 MODERATE | Financial tracing, detainee debriefs, HUMINT. |

07 // BEHAVIORAL

Applied Behavioral Tradecraft

Behavioral tradecraft is applied here because pirate actor decisions are sensitive to perceived risk-reward ratios and deterrence signals, both of which are observable through incident tempo, advisory posture, and operational adaptation. Analysis is grounded in observable evidence only.

| RANK | BEHAVIORAL RISK DRIVER AND EVIDENCE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01   | Risk-Reward Recalibration. Pirate actors are likely updating perceived risk after successful or partially successful incidents. Lower perceived interdiction risk increases willingness to attempt farther offshore operations. Evidence basis: incident tempo, severe advisory posture, mothership reports. |
| 02   | Copycat Activation. Recent success can create imitation incentives among coastal groups if piracy appears profitable, locally tolerated, or weakly punished. Warning trigger: new recruitment signals, additional dhow seizures, ransom narratives.                                                          |
| 03   | Narrative Legitimization. Anti-illegal-fishing and coastal-survival narratives may provide permissive framing even when the operational behavior remains criminal predation. Caveat: narrative evidence should not be treated as factual justification for incident attribution.                             |
| 04   | Deterrence Perception. If pirates perceive naval forces as diverted by Red Sea or regional crises, the subjective cost of attack decreases even if actual naval capacity remains significant. Collection need: compare incident timing against visible patrol density and response time.                     |

**Behavioral Tradecraft Boundary:** This section models incentives, observable behaviors, and warning indicators. It does not infer individual psychology, clan determinism, or unsupported ideological intent.

08 // IMPLICATIONS

Strategic Implications, Risk, and Recommendations

A. STRATEGIC IMPLICATIONS BY ACTOR

| ACTOR                           | IMPLICATIONS AND PRIORITY ACTIONS                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Maritime Operators              | Review BMP-MS measures and citadel readiness. Screen vessel speed, freeboard, and route predictability. Register with appropriate maritime reporting centers and maintain vigilant watch.      |
| Naval Planners                  | Prioritize dhow mothership identification and interdiction. Increase patrol unpredictability near Puntland-linked operating zones. Fuse EUNAVFOR, CMF, UKMTO, MSCIO, and flag-state reporting. |
| NGO Security Directors          | Require dynamic route-risk approval for maritime movement. Suspend nonessential exposed coastal transit when thresholds turn red. Include piracy triggers in SRM escalation matrices.          |
| Insurers and Logistics Analysts | Monitor premium movement for Somali Basin routes. Track vessel detention duration and ransom claims. Stress-test rerouting costs and delay exposure.                                           |

B. RECOMMENDATIONS BY TIME HORIZON

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0-72H<br>IMMEDIATE        | Issue route-specific piracy advisories for vulnerable vessels, confirm reporting procedures, review citadel readiness, and ensure bridge teams understand PAG and mothership indicators. |
| 3-30 DAYS<br>NEAR-TERM    | Implement dynamic route-risk approval, refine armed security criteria where lawful, and coordinate with maritime security centers for transit planning.                                  |
| 30-90 DAYS<br>MEDIUM-TERM | Build a piracy monitoring dashboard that tracks dhow seizures, PAG approaches, advisory posture, ransom signals, and insurance movement.                                                 |

09 // CONFIDENCE

Confidence and Uncertainties

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| OVERALL CONFIDENCE<br>ASSESSMENT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MODERATE-HIGH |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Confidence is moderate-high for the existence of an active piracy threat cycle: primary maritime authorities report specific incidents, threat posture, and mothership activity across independent reporting channels.</li><li>• Confidence is moderate for causal drivers: deterrence perception, economic stress, and regional distraction are plausible enabling conditions but are not fully measurable from public sources.</li><li>• Confidence is low for insurgent or Houthi operational linkage: insufficient public evidence supports this claim and it remains below key-judgment threshold.</li></ul> |               |

THREE UNCERTAINTIES THAT COULD FLIP THE ASSESSMENT

|              |                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FLIP RISK 01 | If no further incidents occur and held vessels are recovered without ransom, the baseline may shift from sustained resurgence to temporary spike. |
| FLIP RISK 02 | If direct financial or communications links to insurgent actors emerge, the assessment would shift toward hybrid criminal-insurgent financing.    |
| FLIP RISK 03 | If additional offshore approaches occur beyond 500 nm, threat geography and insurance implications should be upgraded.                            |

ASSUMPTION FAILURE DRILL

|                                              |                                                                                         |                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ASSUMPTION                                   | FAILURE SIGNAL                                                                          | CONSEQUENCE                                                                |
| Incidents are attributable to Somali PAGs.   | Non-Somali actor confirmed; incident geography or method inconsistent with PAG pattern. | Attribution chain fails; response planning misdirected.                    |
| Mothership use indicates organized planning. | Dhow seizure found to be opportunistic theft unlinked to offshore piracy.               | Network reconstitution judgment overstated; confidence downgrade required. |

## 10 // REFERENCES

## Source Register and WSI Audit

RAPITIS: R = Reliability | A = Access | P = Provenance | M = Manipulation Risk | T = Timeliness | I = Independence | S = Specificity. Claim scoring: C = Corroboration | D = Diagnosticity | F = Falsifiability. Bands: Green = Strong | Amber = Mixed | Red = Lead-only.

| #  | SOURCE                             | TYPE                   | BAND  | INDEPENDENCE                               | URL / LOCATOR               | ATOMIC CLAIM / FALSIFIABILITY                                                                                                                                                              |
|----|------------------------------------|------------------------|-------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| S1 | EUNAVFOR Operation ATALANTA        | Tier A / Primary       | GREEN | Independent of UKMTO/JMIC                  | eunavfor.eu/news/...        | EUNAVFOR confirmed incidents involving HONOUR 25 and SWARD and investigated a dhow possibly linked to SWARD. RAPITIS: R5 A5 P5 M4 T5 I4 S5   C5 D5 F5                                      |
| S2 | UKMTO / JMIC Advisory 041          | Tier A / Primary       | GREEN | Independent naval authority                | ukmto.org advisory PDF      | Pirate Action Group activity assessed as highly likely across Somali Coast and Somali Basin, with severe threat posture. RAPITIS: R5 A5 P4 M4 T5 I4 S5   C5 D5 F5                          |
| S3 | UKMTO / JMIC Advisory 039          | Tier A / Primary       | GREEN | Same channel as S2; prior reporting period | ukmto.org advisory PDF      | Piracy threat elevated to severe; suspected PAG activity far offshore. RAPITIS: R5 A5 P4 M4 T5 I4 S5   C5 D4 F5                                                                            |
| S4 | Combined Maritime Forces / CTF-151 | Tier A / Primary       | GREEN | Independent naval reporting                | combinedmaritimeforce.s.com | CTF-151 and partners disrupted pirate operations and forced actors toward the Somali coastline. RAPITIS: R5 A5 P4 M4 T5 I4 S4   C4 D4 F5                                                   |
| S5 | IMB Piracy Reporting Centre        | Tier A / Institutional | GREEN | Independent maritime body                  | iccwbo.org                  | Q1 2026 piracy levels were low globally but Somalia remained a watch area requiring vigilance. RAPITIS: R5 A4 P5 M4 T4 I4 S4   C4 D3 F5                                                    |
| S6 | Barron's / AFP                     | Tier B / Context       | AMBER | Derivative of upstream sources             | barrons.com                 | Secondary reporting links piracy concern to reduced antipiracy posture, hunger, illegal fishing, and regional maritime distraction. Context only. RAPITIS: R4 A3 P4 M3 T5 I3 S3   C3 D3 F4 |

**Band Key:** Green = high credibility, multi-source corroborated; Amber = single credible source or partial corroboration; Red = contested, unverified, or single low-reliability source.

**Independence Test Statement:** EUNAVFOR, UKMTO/JMIC, CMF/CTF-151, and IMB represent distinct reporting pathways. News products that summarize those streams are not counted as independent corroboration for load-bearing incident claims. Syndicated reporting from the same UKMTO/JMIC or EUNAVFOR advisories is treated as a single corroboration stream regardless of how many outlets carry the story.

## A // EARLY WARNING

## Early Warning Indicators

| INDICATOR          | GREEN // MONITOR          | AMBER // WATCH                         | RED // EMERGENCY                         | OWNER                     |
|--------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Dhow hijackings    | No new reports in 14 days | One new credible report                | Two or more confirmed reports            | Maritime security watch   |
| PAG offshore range | Nearshore only            | 300 nm offshore                        | 500 nm or farther offshore               | Naval intel cell          |
| Vessel holding     | No held vessels           | One vessel held                        | Multiple vessels held or tanker held     | Shipping risk desk        |
| Ransom signals     | No credible demand        | Unconfirmed demand                     | Verified ransom channel or payment claim | Insurer / crisis response |
| Threat advisories  | Moderate or lower         | Substantial or severe less than 7 days | Severe sustained for 14 days             | Risk operations center    |



## B // INTEL GAPS

## Priority Intelligence Gaps and Action Thresholds

## B.1 PRIORITY INTELLIGENCE GAPS

| GAP ID | INTELLIGENCE QUESTION                              | WHY IT MATTERS                                           | COLLECTION PATH                                       |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| G1     | What is the command structure of active PAGs?      | Determines whether activity is networked or diffuse.     | Detainee debriefs, local reporting, pattern analysis. |
| G2     | What is the current state of ransom economics?     | Determines whether copycat activation is likely.         | Insurance, crisis response, release timelines.        |
| G3     | How many motherships are currently active?         | Determines offshore reach and attack persistence.        | AIS anomaly detection, dhow reports, naval sightings. |
| G4     | Is there any credible insurgent facilitation link? | Would shift from criminal piracy to hybrid threat model. | Financial tracing, communications, HUMINT, detainees. |

## B.2 ACTION THRESHOLDS

| BAND             | TRIGGER CONDITION                                                                        | REQUIRED ACTIONS                                                                                            | RESPONSIBLE PARTIES                                             |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| GREEN // MONITOR | Situation within acceptable parameters; no new escalatory indicators.                    | Maintain monitoring posture, continue reporting register, update advisories.                                | Risk operations center, maritime reporting officers.            |
| AMBER // ACT NOW | Elevated risk; one or more indicators breach amber threshold.                            | Issue route-specific advisories, review armed security plans, flag to naval liaisons.                       | Security directors, naval coordinators, shipping risk desks.    |
| RED // EMERGENCY | Critical threshold breached; multiple vessels held, tanker targeted, or ransom verified. | Suspend nonessential maritime transit, activate crisis protocols, notify flag states and naval authorities. | Senior security leadership, legal, naval crisis cell, insurers. |

Produced under the Quanta Analytica Process™ by MNS Consulting

*This report is an evidence-caveated public OSINT analytic product. It does not include classified streams, private insurer data, or non-public maritime intelligence.*